PREPARED FOR TIFFANY WHEELER · ARROWLEAF MARKETING · OCTOBER 2026

Shopify or WooCommerce: which should run the new store?

The new tiffany-wheeler.com is built and works the same in front of either one. This page compares what runs behind it: products, cart, checkout, payments, orders and PDF downloads. Judged on one thing first: how many ad visitors become buyers.

Our recommendation: Shopify

Your sales come from Facebook and Instagram ads, mostly on phones, mostly in the six weeks before Christmas. That makes the checkout the most important page on the site, and checkout is where the two platforms differ most.

- **Faster checkout for phone buyers.** Shop Pay, Apple Pay, Google Pay and PayPal are built in. Today your WooCommerce checkout takes cards only.
- **Holds up in the Christmas rush.** Shopify runs checkout on its own servers. WooCommerce runs it on your WordPress hosting, at the exact moment traffic peaks.
- **Less to break and maintain.** No WordPress plugins to update or secure, and the new site connects to Shopify through its official tools.

The trade-off is a monthly fee (about **$29–39**) and a one-time move of your products and reviews, which we handle. WooCommerce is the better pick only if keeping everything inside WordPress matters more to you than checkout speed.

What we're optimizing for

A parent or grandparent sees your ad, taps it inside the Facebook or Instagram app, and lands on the site on their phone. Each extra step, each field to type, each slow page loses some of them. So the questions that matter are: how quickly can they pay, does it work inside the app, and does it stay fast on the busiest days of the year?

1. Checkout and conversions (the part that matters most)

QUESTION	SHOPIFY	WOOCOMMERCE
How fast can a phone buyer pay?	Shop Pay fills in name, address and card in one step for anyone who has used it at another Shopify store. Apple Pay, Google Pay and PayPal also appear at the top of checkout. Shopify reports Shop Pay converts up to 50% better than guest checkout. SHOPIFY	Your checkout today offers **credit and debit cards only**, through Stripe. Apple Pay and Google Pay can be added through the Stripe plugin, but there is no Shop Pay network.

QUESTION	SHOPIFY	WOOCOMMERCE
Does it work inside the Facebook and Instagram apps?	Apple Pay often doesn't appear inside those in-app browsers. Shop Pay still works there (it verifies with a text code), so a fast option is always on screen. SHOPIFY	Same Apple Pay limitation, and no Shop Pay fallback. In-app buyers type their card and address by hand.
Will it hold up on the busiest days?	Checkout runs on Shopify's servers, which handle Black Friday traffic for millions of stores. Your site's traffic doesn't slow it down. SHOPIFY	Checkout runs on your WordPress hosting. A slow or overloaded host means a slow checkout, or an outage, exactly when ads are spending the most.
How cleanly does it connect to the new site?	Official tools made for this: the new site builds the cart and hands the buyer to Shopify's checkout in one click. SHOPIFY	WooCommerce has an official API for products and cart, but **no official way to hand a cart to its checkout page**. Options are a third-party plugin (CoCart) or building and maintaining our own checkout, including payments, tax and shipping.
Abandoned carts	Abandoned-checkout emails are built in, and Klaviyo connects natively for reminder sequences. SHOPIFY	Needs a plugin or a Klaviyo setup. Doable, more moving parts.
Upsell after purchase	Post-purchase offer apps (for example "add an ornament for $2.99") run on Shopify's checkout and work with the new site.	Possible through plugins on your WordPress checkout.
Bundles and the 5+ book discount	The Complete Set works as a real bundle with an honest "if bought separately" price. "10% off 5 or more books" is a built-in automatic discount. EVEN	Both work today, through Woo Discount Rules Pro (a paid plugin). EVEN
Tracking ad sales	Shopify's Meta and Google apps send purchases from checkout, including Meta's Conversions API, so ads optimize on real sales. SHOPIFY	Meta plugins for WooCommerce exist and work, but purchase tracking depends on the plugin and your host staying healthy.

Why this matters in dollars: if 2 of every 100 ad visitors buy today, faster payment options typically move that number in the right direction, and on ad traffic even a small lift pays for the monthly fee many times over in a single Christmas season. We'll measure it once ads are live rather than promise a number.

2. Cost

	SHOPIFY	WOOCOMMERCE
Platform	$39/month, or $29/month billed yearly (Basic plan, which is all you need).	Free plugin. WOOCOMMERCE

	SHOPIFY	WOOCOMMERCE
Card fees	2.9% + 30¢ per online order with Shopify Payments (Shop Pay is the same rate). Using a different processor adds 2%.	2.9% + 30¢ per order with Stripe, the same as today. EVEN
Hosting	Included for the store. The new site's hosting is the same either way.	You keep paying for WordPress hosting, and a busier site may need a bigger plan for December.
Add-ons	Digital downloads and reviews (Judge.me) have free tiers. Klaviyo is the same on both.	Your current paid plugins renew yearly (Table Rate Shipping, Discount Rules Pro, Gravity Forms, the Stripe plugin's pro features if used).
Upkeep	No plugins or WordPress updates to manage. SHOPIFY	WordPress, theme and plugin updates, plus security, are ongoing work and ongoing risk.

Net: Shopify costs roughly $350–470 more per year before subtracting the hosting and plugin renewals it replaces. Card fees, the biggest cost, are the same on both.

3. Running the store day to day

Shopify

- One admin and a phone app for orders, inventory and payouts.
- Discounted USPS labels printed from the order screen.
- Sales tax calculated automatically.
- PDF downloads delivered by protected, expiring links.
- Your 21 existing reviews can be imported into Judge.me, so the stars carry over.

WooCommerce

- You already know the admin, and your order and customer history stays where it is.
- Labels and taxes through plugins or a service like ShipStation.
- PDFs are native, but **four paid Nephite Christmas PDFs are currently downloadable by anyone** from your uploads folder. That needs fixing either way.
- Full ownership: no platform can change terms or fees on you.

4. The switch itself

Moving to Shopify

- Small catalog (15 products), so the move is quick. We handle it.
- Reviews import. Customers can be imported; past orders stay viewable in WooCommerce as an archive.
- Old product links already redirect to the new pages, so ads, Google and shared links keep working.
- Fits the launch target of early November, before Black Friday.

Staying on WooCommerce

- No data to move.
- More custom building on our side for checkout, which adds time and risk before Christmas.
- Your WordPress site must stay online, updated and fast, since checkout depends on it.

When WooCommerce would be the right call

If any of these matter more to you than checkout speed, WooCommerce is a reasonable choice and we can build it: you strongly prefer no monthly platform fee; you want everything, including order history, in one place you own; or you rely on a WordPress plugin with no Shopify equivalent. Even then, we'd recommend adding Apple Pay and Google Pay to your Stripe checkout and fixing the public PDFs before ads run.

Questions for you

1. How important is keeping your past WooCommerce orders and customer list in the same system?
2. Who updates and looks after WordPress today, and would you like that job to go away?
3. Are you comfortable with the Shopify Basic plan ($29/month billed yearly)?

Sources

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